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Week 5 Preview

1 message

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SUMER SPORTS



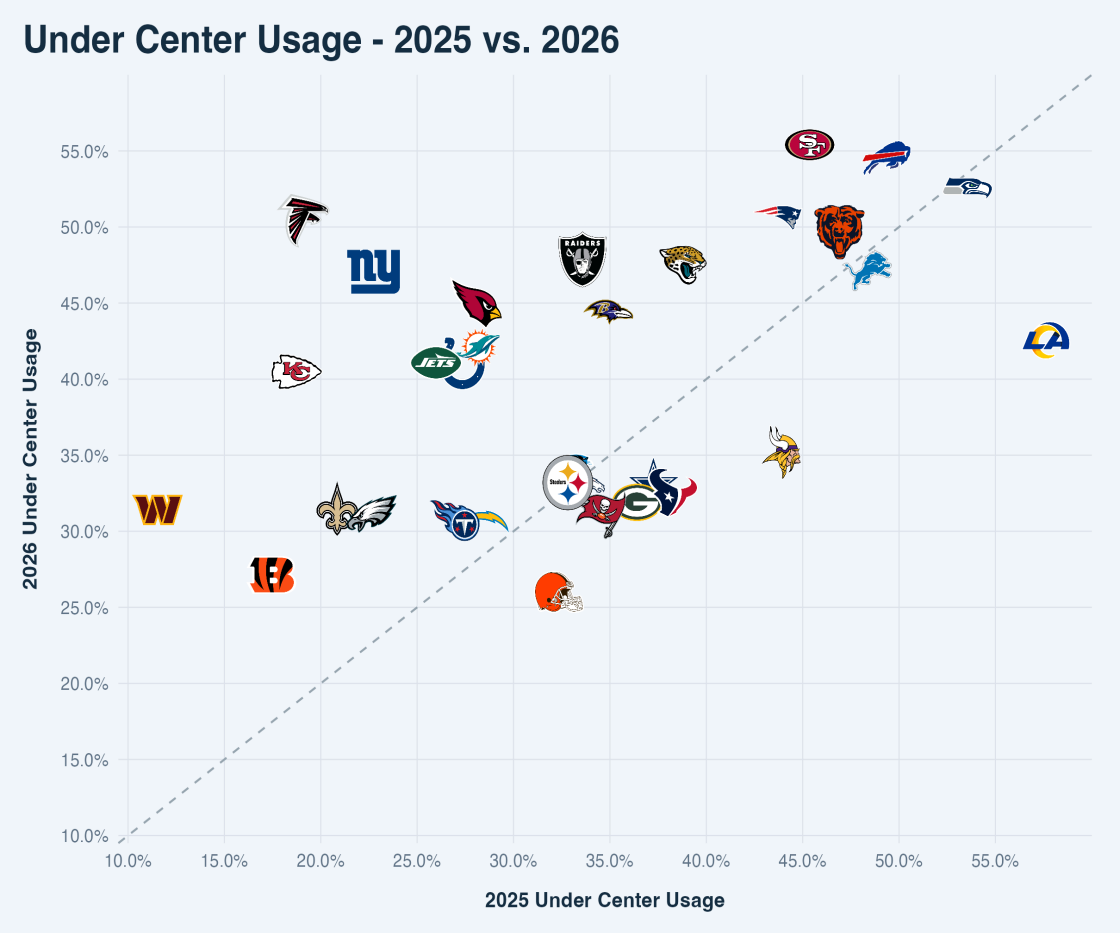
Week 5 Preview

A Quick Note.

- The data you see below comes from SumerSports' SumerPass. We recommend you check it out if you want to dive deeper into the data, build your own stats, or get live charting on game days.
- Today's newsletter has some thoughts on under center usage, our film favorites, and our three biggest questions of the week along with their respective preview boxes. For the rest of the game preview boxes, head over to Tej's page where they will all be posted Thursday.

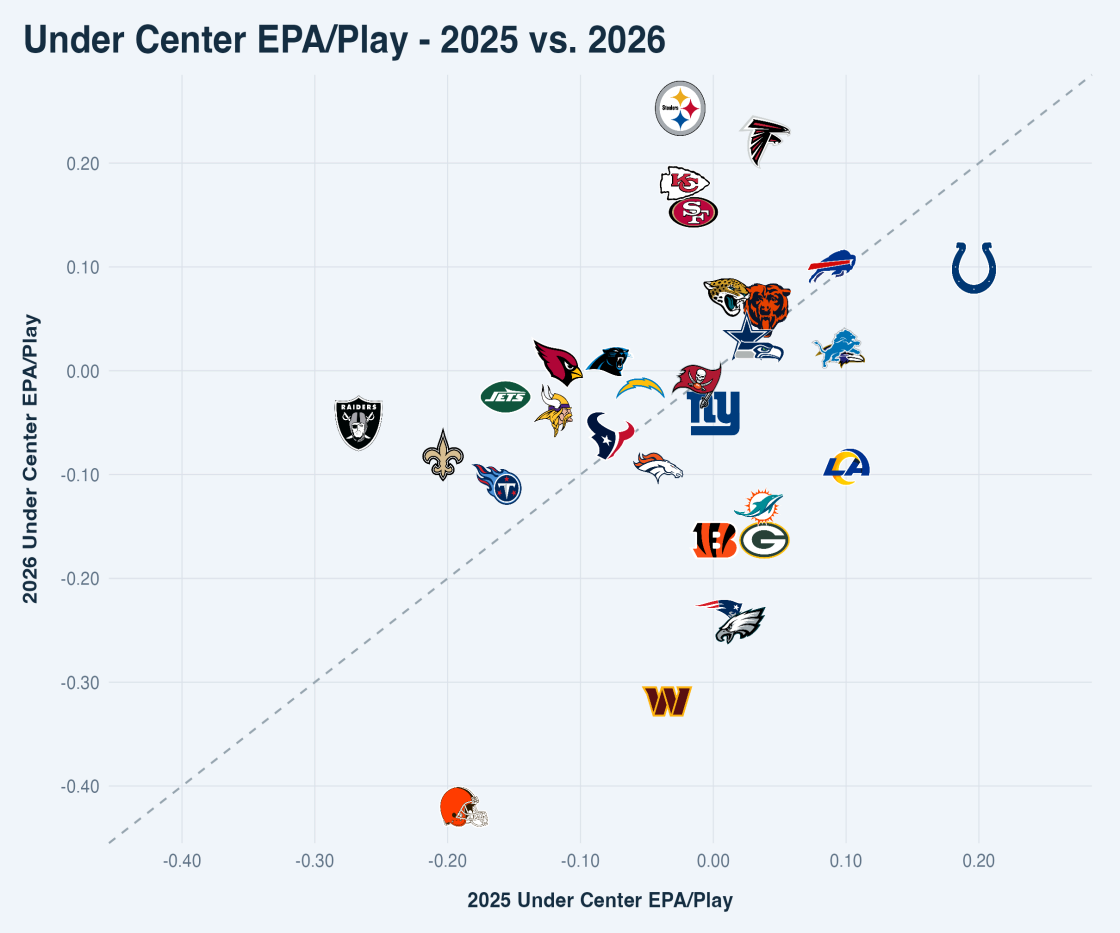
Under Center Check-In

Last season, seven teams were under center less than 25% of the time. Through four weeks in 2026, that number is zero.



- Here are some of the notable movers so far in 2025 (full season) under center usage to 2026:
    - Falcons: 19.1% to 50.4%
    - Giants: 22.7% to 47.1%
    - Chiefs: 18.8% to 40.5%
    - Raiders: 33.5% to 47.9%

The Chiefs are an early winner in the shift to more under center.



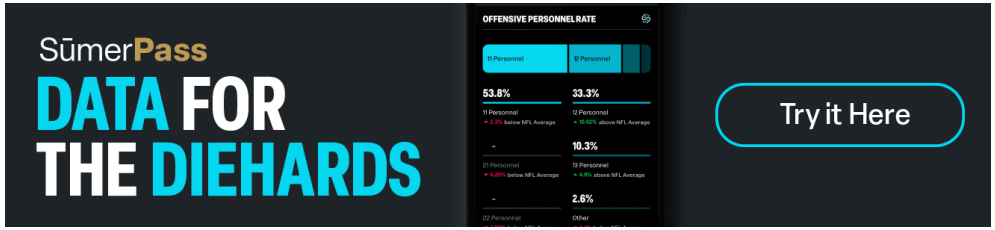
- The Chiefs have used under center play action and an under center zone running approach that highlights Kenneth Walker's ability to hit home runs on any snap. The interior of their offensive line has also had some great reps so far this year. Here are some of their 2025 vs. 2026 numbers when under center:
    - Usage: 18.8% (30th) to 40.5% (17th)
    - Under center EPA/Play: 0.00 (16th) to 0.17 (3rd)
    - Under center success rate: 38.8% (28th) to 51.0% (4th)
    - Kenneth Walker has 54 carries for 388 yards and nine explosive carries on under center runs.
    - The Chiefs can also pass from under center where they have 28 play action dropbacks for 306 yards and 0.48 EPA/play.

Look at the Falcons!

- The Falcons are noteworthy given how Michael Penix Jr.'s usage has changed.
    - In 2025, Penix Jr. was under center for just 2.7% of snaps. He is at 59.3% in 2026. He is 9/13 for 146 yards and a touchdown on under center play action so far this year.
    - Bijan Robinson has 63 under center rushes for 388 yards and four touchdowns. He has nine explosive runs and 6.16 yards per carry on those plays. Robinson is a force on outside zone and Atlanta has shown multiple small tweaks to make them harder to play against.

Some other quick notes.

- The Los Angeles Rams were under center 59.2% of the time last season and are at 42.7% this year after using an up tempo attack to come back against the Eagles.
- The Eagles increased their rate from 22.2% to 31.1% but rank 28th in under enter usage.
- The only team that did not change their under center usage ranking in either direction is the Cincinnati Bengals. Their 17.5% usage last year and 27.1% usage this year are both good for 31st.



Film Favorites

Here are some interesting things from the all-22 this week with clips hyperlinked:

- Chris Shula and the Rams joined the list of teams to run the NFL's favorite weakside overload pressure.
- The Giants went spread from heavy to get Malik Nabers matched up with a linebacker.
- Declan Doyle ran a dash pass with a twist.
- The Commanders got creative in the quarterback run game.
- Travis Hunter is opening up the Jaguars ability to play man coverage.
- Two pretty zone reps.
- Klint Kubiak continues to get creative.
- Rashid Shaheed took snaps in the backfield.
- A nice way to change things up on a core boot play.

Week 5 Questions We Want Answered

San Francisco 49ers @ Seattle Seahawks: Can the Seahawks slow down Brock Purdy?

- In the first three meetings between Mike Macdonald and Brock Purdy, Purdy had 87th, 65th, and 87th percentile performances by EPA/dropback. In the last two, Macdonald's swarming Seahawks held Purdy to a 10th and 5th percentile EPA/dropback. Macdonald has been able to increase his usage of cover 4 and other post snap two high coverages against the 49ers.
- Seattle's defense is 2nd in EPA/play allowed but is 19th in EPA/play allowed on throws happening quicker than 2.5 seconds. The Seahawks are also 28th in EPA/play allowed on short throws, so we will be on the lookout for throws under 10 yards. We also want to see if Brock Purdy can maintain his 0% sack rate on the season and if Mike Evans is able to maintain his per target production through his injury.

SF Offense vs. SEA Defense

Week 5 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-4 data · raw EPA • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
SF Offense	0.27 (#1)	0.54 (#1)	-0.06 (#11)	54.5% (#1)	5.4% (#5)	14.0% (#3)
SEA Defense	-0.18 (#2)	-0.12 (#4)	-0.26 (#2)	36.7% (#2)	-3.8% (#5)	5.7% (#3)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	21P %	21P EPA
SF Offense	32.0% (#31)	0.34 (#1)	15.3% (#26)	0.42 (#2)	41.9% (#1)	0.14 (#7)
SEA Defense	57.6% (#16)	-0.15 (#8)	15.1% (#28)	-0.37 (#1)	13.5% (#5)	-0.04 (#20)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
SF Offense	70.0% (#4)	-0.13 (#17)	26.2% (#17)	0.37 (#4)	55.4% (#1)	0.17 (#4)
SEA Defense	53.9% (#21)	-0.22 (#8)	28.2% (#13)	-0.11 (#6)	37.6% (#20)	-0.24 (#2)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
SF Offense	36.1% (#20)	0.33 (#4)	63.9% (#13)	0.66 (#1)	24.1% (#11)	0.95 (#1)
SEA Defense	18.1% (#29)	-0.49 (#2)	81.9% (#4)	-0.04 (#12)	15.3% (#4)	-0.29 (#2)

Blitz & Pressure

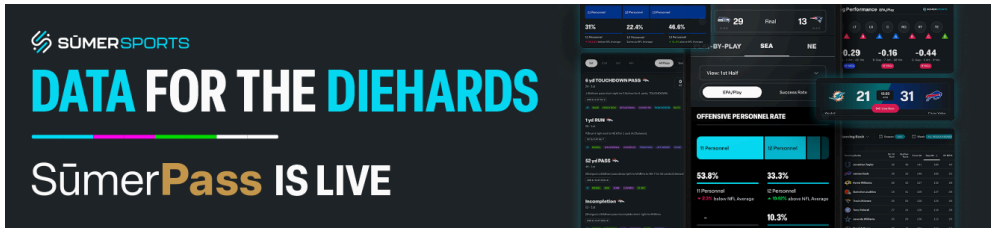
UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
SF Offense	29.5% (#15)	1.06 (#1)	0.33 (#2)	33.6% (#5)	0.19 (#1)
SEA Defense	21.5% (#25)	-0.27 (#6)	-0.08 (#5)	43.6% (#9)	-0.37 (#17)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
SF Offense	63.4% (#21)	0.48 (#1)	28.6% (#2)	0.62 (#6)	8.0% (#27)	0.32 (#18)
SEA Defense	75.0% (#1)	0.21 (#28)	14.5% (#32)	-0.77 (#1)	10.5% (#20)	-0.68 (#1)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
SF Offense	48.6% (#1)	0.29 (#1)	41.4% (#31)	0.24 (#1)	29.7% (#32)	0.52 (#1)
SEA Defense	15.5% (#29)	-0.37 (#3)	68.2% (#10)	-0.23 (#3)	51.4% (#8)	-0.16 (#5)



Buffalo Bills @ Los Angeles Rams: Which version of the Bills offense will we see on Monday night?

- After using 13 personnel over 25% in each of the first three weeks of the season, the Bills used it 13% of the time in Week 4. The Bills were 1st in EPA/play over the first two weeks of the season but 17th in the last two. They have lowered their play action rate, and Dalton Kincaid had just two targets last week.
- Since Week 1, the Rams are 1st in EPA/play allowed and 2nd in success rate allowed. Chris Shula has played man coverage more often and can trust Trent McDuffie in the secondary while the front stunts.
- We will be focused on how the Bills deal with the Rams man coverage. Buffalo is 5th in EPA/dropback against man coverage but 23rd in success rate. Buffalo did struggle against cover 3 and cover 6 last week so Shula may have a more mixed approach.

BUF Offense vs. LA Defense

Week 5 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-4 data · raw EPA • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
BUF Offense	0.16 (#2)	0.24 (#4)	0.05 (#5)	47.6% (#8)	1.7% (#14)	15.5% (#1)
LA Defense	-0.16 (#3)	-0.19 (#2)	-0.13 (#10)	40.5% (#6)	-0.7% (#14)	5.5% (#2)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	13P %	13P EPA
BUF Offense	48.1% (#25)	0.20 (#3)	20.2% (#19)	0.25 (#3)	26.2% (#2)	0.02 (#18)
LA Defense	57.0% (#17)	-0.20 (#5)	17.7% (#23)	-0.12 (#9)	1.3% (#31)	-0.29 (#5)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
BUF Offense	37.8% (#31)	-0.15 (#20)	38.2% (#1)	0.14 (#17)	54.5% (#2)	0.10 (#5)
LA Defense	63.3% (#7)	-0.07 (#22)	21.2% (#31)	-0.25 (#4)	39.7% (#15)	-0.04 (#14)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
BUF Offense	36.8% (#18)	0.36 (#3)	63.2% (#15)	0.18 (#12)	24.4% (#8)	0.43 (#11)
LA Defense	22.6% (#25)	-0.61 (#1)	77.4% (#8)	-0.07 (#9)	19.7% (#13)	0.01 (#10)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
BUF Offense	28.7% (#20)	0.29 (#7)	0.22 (#6)	41.2% (#20)	-0.11 (#6)
LA Defense	32.1% (#11)	-0.51 (#1)	-0.04 (#9)	44.5% (#6)	-0.52 (#10)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER %	INTER EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
BUF Offense	59.7% (#27)	0.05 (#15)	22.7% (#14)	0.52 (#11)	17.6% (#4)	1.02 (#6)
LA Defense	73.2% (#2)	-0.20 (#3)	17.3% (#27)	0.19 (#10)	9.4% (#24)	-0.63 (#2)

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
BUF Offense	30.5% (#16)	0.19 (#5)	61.8% (#14)	0.14 (#6)	37.3% (#27)	0.27 (#5)
LA Defense	24.9% (#22)	-0.17 (#7)	40.9% (#31)	-0.10 (#9)	51.5% (#7)	-0.15 (#6)

Las Vegas Raiders @ New England Patriots: Will Drake Maye and the Patriots offense continue to clean things up?

- Drake Maye had a -0.18 EPA/dropback in Weeks 1-3 but a 0.30 EPA/dropback in Week 4. He found more success on intermediate throws, and the Patriots play action rate went up.
- The Raiders defense is 6th in EPA/play allowed and has made splash plays this season. They are living in nickel and should be able to get pressure in this game. The Patriots are 31st in pressure rate allowed while the Raiders are 7th in pressure rate generated without having to blitz a ton.
- A pressure mismatch may lead to more short passes for the Patriots. The Patriots rank 18th in success rate when throwing short passes, and the Raiders rank 31st against those types of throws. The best plan to beat the pressure this week may be getting the ball out short in a hurry.

NE Offense vs. LV Defense

Week 5 preview • 2026 Weeks 1-4 data · raw EPA • Each cell shows value and NFL rank

Overall

UNIT	EPA/PLAY	EPA/DB	EPA/RUSH	SUCCESS RATE	PASS OE	EXPLOSIVE %
NE Offense	-0.09 (#22)	-0.04 (#21)	-0.15 (#21)	44.2% (#17)	0.2% (#16)	9.6% (#12)
LV Defense	-0.10 (#6)	-0.07 (#8)	-0.13 (#9)	42.7% (#11)	-1.7% (#11)	9.5% (#16)

Personnel Usage

UNIT	11P %	11P EPA	12P %	12P EPA	21P %	21P EPA
NE Offense	60.2% (#16)	0.02 (#11)	16.5% (#22)	-0.29 (#28)	14.1% (#7)	-0.35 (#19)
LV Defense	55.2% (#21)	-0.20 (#6)	19.1% (#22)	-0.08 (#12)	17.4% (#3)	-0.03 (#21)

Run & Play Action Identity

UNIT	ZONE %	ZONE EPA	PA %	PA EPA	UC %	UC EPA
NE Offense	36.4% (#32)	-0.21 (#23)	25.9% (#19)	-0.37 (#32)	50.6% (#4)	-0.23 (#29)
LV Defense	60.2% (#12)	-0.17 (#13)	25.3% (#18)	0.13 (#18)	31.7% (#32)	0.15 (#31)

Safety Shell & Middle of Field

UNIT	1-HIGH %	1-HIGH EPA	2-HIGH %	2-HIGH EPA	MOF %	MOF EPA
NE Offense	41.9% (#8)	0.01 (#15)	58.1% (#25)	-0.08 (#22)	13.0% (#30)	0.21 (#17)
LV Defense	22.6% (#26)	0.01 (#19)	77.4% (#7)	-0.10 (#5)	15.9% (#5)	-0.28 (#3)

Blitz & Pressure

UNIT	BLITZ %	BLITZ EPA	NON-BLITZ EPA	PRESSURE %	PRESSURE EPA
NE Offense	29.1% (#17)	0.09 (#13)	-0.10 (#27)	48.6% (#31)	-0.21 (#11)
LV Defense	21.2% (#26)	-0.47 (#3)	0.03 (#15)	44.5% (#7)	-0.63 (#2)

Pass Depth

UNIT	SHORT %	SHORT EPA	INTER. %	INTER. EPA	DEEP %	DEEP EPA
NE Offense	56.9% #30	-0.14 #27	27.6% #3	0.30 #23	15.4% #7	0.03 #22
LV Defense	57.1% #28	0.15 #26	23.0% #10	0.25 #13	19.8% #2	-0.29 #5

Defensive Personnel & Box Count

UNIT	BASE %	BASE EPA	NICKEL %	NICKEL EPA	LIGHT BOX %	LIGHT BOX EPA
NE Offense	31.7% #13	-0.18 #28	61.0% #16	0.00 #16	43.4% #17	-0.05 #20
LV Defense	15.8% #27	-0.17 #6	81.3% #4	-0.08 #12	52.3% #6	-0.26 #3

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